

Page 1: Vocabulary & Reading

English News Hub | *Mortgage Rates Reach 7% in the USA (24th September 2026)*

1. Vocabulary Focus

Match the words on the left with their correct definitions on the right:

1. Mortgage ____	• A. A psychological barrier or block
2. Mental hurdle ____	• B. The highest point
3. Landmark ____	• C. A significant moment
4. Peak ____	• D. A loan to buy a house
5. Inflation ____	• E. General increase in prices over time
6. Fixed rate ____	• F. The interest stays the same for the total duration
7. Kick-start ____	• G. Give something a push to make it move again
8. Standard / New norm ____	• H. Something unusual that has now become expected

2. Reading Text: Mortgage Rates Reach 7% in the USA

Read the article and underline any new words or expressions.

Mortgage rates reached a major landmark this week, rising above 7% for the first time since early 2025. According to official data, the average 30-year fixed rate went up to 7.03%. This is the fifth week in a row that rates have increased, making it even harder for people to buy a home.

Experts warn that going above 7% acts as a mental hurdle that could slow down property sales this autumn. Although rates are still lower than their peak of 7.79% in 2023, recent hopes for a market recovery have quickly disappeared.

A few months ago, rates briefly dropped below 6%, making people hopeful that cheaper loans would kick-start buying and selling again. However, rising oil prices caused by conflict in Iran have pushed inflation up, driving borrowing costs back higher.

The extra cost for buyers is huge. Anyone getting a mortgage today on an average home will pay thousands of dollars more over 30 years compared to someone who bought in February. Because of this, experts believe that 7% is now the standard rate buyers should expect.

(Adapted from cnn.com)

Page 2: Comprehension & Discussion

3. Reading Comprehension

Answer the questions based on the text:

1. How many consecutive weeks have interest rates increased?

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2. In which season might house sales go down?

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3. Which conflict has caused the cost of oil to go up?

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4. What is the standard mortgage rate that buyers should now expect?

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4. Discussion & Hot Takes

Discuss these statements with a partner. Do you agree or disagree?

- **Statement 1:** *“These days, the prospect of being in the same place for 30 years is a mental hurdle for young people.”*
- **Statement 2:** *“If inflation continues to increase more than salaries, regular families won't be able to afford luxuries in the near future.”*
- **Statement 3:** *“The current generation of young people will be living with their parents until they are in their 40s.”*

5. Final Debate Task

Choose one of the topics below to debate with your partner. Try to use the vocabulary and useful phrases provided.

- **Topic 1:** *It is a much better idea to rent a house or flat than to buy one.*
- **Topic 2:** *The price of houses is the main reason why people are buying fewer properties.*

Useful Phrases for Debating:

- I see your point. However...
- I'm afraid I disagree...
- I agree to an extent, but...
- I completely disagree...